Kevan Maxwell Davis

Staff Software Engineer | AI Product Experiences, Frontend Architecture & Developer Tools

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Hands-on Staff Software Engineer with 20 years building customer-facing products, developer platforms, and extensible frontend systems. Deep TypeScript/React experience and recent focus on AI-powered creation tools, coding agents, model integrations, and intuitive developer interfaces. Combines product judgment with rapid prototyping, practical API design, and technical leadership. Based in Colorado and willing to travel regularly to San Francisco.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend & product: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Remix, CSS Modules, SPA architecture, UI extensibility, developer experience, API design, rapid prototyping

AI & agents: Vercel AI SDK, Pi (RPC/extensions), MCP, OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, multimodal generation, agent orchestration, model routing and fallbacks, evaluation workflows

Backend & tools: Node.js, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Prisma, Ruby on Rails, Docker, Kubernetes; browser- and Node-compatible shared libraries

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shopify | Staff Software Engineer | 2021–2026

- Re-architected **Shopp-E**, an existing internal AI creation tool, into an isomorphic **TypeScript library built on Vercel AI SDK**, powering a React web interface, CLI, and MCP integration for people and coding agents. It supported an estimated **hundreds of daily users** and generated **100,000+ images**.
- Designed a unified model registry spanning image, video, speech, and music providers, with capability and cost metadata, asynchronous job handling, outage fallbacks, and polling for long-running video tasks. Kept model-specific complexity behind reusable interfaces.
- Built hands-on **Pi coding-agent extensions**: a rich Markdown editor with attachments and extensible panes, web-to-Markdown retrieval, and a fast multi-model safety-review workflow with human override. Collaborated on **Pi IDE** interface primitives for prompts, dialogs, and notifications.
- Designed an AI-assisted migration prototype for customized Liquid email templates. Used structured transformations, syntax/render checks, vision-model screenshot comparisons, and human review to achieve **90% success on a small curated benchmark**; served as technical lead for **six engineers** during subsequent production development. The project was canceled before launch.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

- Built a working **multi-agent code-review experience** using lightweight change classification to route work to specialist reviewers, then aggregate findings into guided pull-request tours and diagrams; piloted with a small group of engineers.
- Extended Shopify's UI-extension architecture to the **Admin product details page**, creating the first **Bundles** extension card. Contributed to the Bundles Admin app and checkout behavior, mentoring junior engineers and an intern.
- Built product-attribute coverage calculations and visual explanations of rule inheritance for multichannel commerce; prototyped a bulk-editing experience for functionality shipped in 2026.

Shopify | Senior Software Engineer | 2019–2021

- Co-designed and prototyped the **developer-facing APIs and React extension model** for Checkout UI Extensions, partnering with a Principal Engineer on integration with sandboxed remote UI. Core concepts informed the eventual production platform.
- Helped develop native B2B capabilities after Shopify acquired Handshake, including business customers and payment terms; contributed to a post-checkout upsell experience and was named co-inventor on U.S. Patent 11,403,658.

Handshake (acquired by Shopify) | Senior Software Developer / Engineer | October 2014–May 2019

- As part of a small frontend team, helped modernize a multi-tenant wholesale commerce product from jQuery/Mustache toward **React**, working across catalogs, self-service ordering, storefronts, and checkout.

Gilt Groupe | Web Developer → Senior Web Developer | April 2009–August 2014

- Built frontend libraries, asset and deployment tooling, cart and checkout experiences, and responsive interfaces for a large consumer ecommerce platform; mentored engineers.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Web Developer, Mindspark Interactive Networks (2008–2009); Developer, Tyler Technologies (2006–2008); Research Assistant, University of Texas at Arlington AI Lab (through 2006).

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington | Bachelor of Science, Computer Science